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Rubicon Global

Nate Morris and Lane Moore, co-founders of Rubicon Global, chatted as they walked down the hall in late November 2014 to an important board meeting. They were eager to get closure on the terms of a new round of financing that the company hoped to raise by early 2015. Rubicon had raised slightly more than $5 million since it was formed in 2008. The team had validated the core business model, and this new round of financing would enable the company to expand rapidly to fulfill its mission of transforming the waste management and recycling industry.

Rubicon was at an important inflection point. The company had started with a bold idea: create a cloud-based, full service waste management company providing low-cost, highly efficient, and environmentally friendly service anywhere in the country through a national network of independent waste haulers and recyclers. Rubicon would use the free market economy to solve a global environmental problem while promoting independent haulers. These companies were typically unable to compete against the two major landfill companies in the U.S. Rubicon had developed a sophisticated software system that optimized routes and recycling, resulting in lower net fees to the customer and far less indiscriminate dumping of unsorted waste in landfills. A player in the sharing economy, Rubicon was developing an on-demand mobile application that did for waste management what Uber had done for taxi service. A quote from the *New York Times*, "An Uber for trash[1]," caught the attention of investors like Forbes 400 members, founder and CEO of Salesforce, Marc Benioff and conservationist Brad Kelley.

It was an audacious plan that entailed going head-to-head with the two industry giant, Waste Management (NYSE: WM) and Republic Services (NYSE: RSG). Those companies had different business models: they typically owned the trucks and the landfills. They derived most of their profit from maximizing volume in landfills and by increasing pick-ups at each service location. Rubicon intended to align its incentives with the customer—fewer pickups—and the environment—more recycling, passing along savings to the customer.

Rubicon had made great progress since introducing its service. They had signed up some large multi-national customers. They also had a number of large potential contracts in the negotiation phase. The team needed more capital to build out the network and technology platform.

Professor William A. Sahlman and Research Associate Hunter Ashmore prepared this case. It was reviewed and approved before publication by a company designate. Funding for the development of this case was provided by Harvard Business School and not by the company. Professor William A. Sahlman is an investor in Rubicon. HBS cases are developed solely as the basis for class discussion. Cases are not intended to serve as endorsements, sources of primary data, or illustrations of effective or ineffective management.

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As Rubicon had grown and garnered favorable press, Morris had been named to *Fortune Magazine's* 2014 "Fortune 40 under 40." Investors who had expressed interest in investing approached the company. Management and the board had to make a number of critical decisions: how much should the company raise, for what purpose, from whom, and on what terms? Morris and Moore looked forward to a lively board discussion and a plan to position Rubicon as a dominant, socially responsible player in the $64 billion waste industry.

Nate Morris: From Politician to Entrepreneur

Nate Morris was born in 1980 in Lexington, Kentucky. He had envisioned a career in politics from an early age, inspired by his grandfather who had been a politically engaged union leader. Raised by a single mother, he later attended George Washington University as a Scottish Rite Scholar. As a student, he held numerous congressional internships and worked in the Bush White House. After graduation, he held a prominent fundraising role in George W. Bush's 2004 re-election campaign. After working in Kentucky's China-based trade office, he enrolled in a graduate program at the Woodrow Wilson School of Public and International Affairs at Princeton University.

While politics had always been a central career goal, Morris intended to earn a living in business. During graduate school, Morris decided to pursue this dream and began searching for business ideas. In 2008, he found an opportunity through a high school friend, Marc Spiegel, whose family had been in the garbage hauling trade for more than a century.

Spiegel talked to Morris about Oakleaf, a rapidly growing waste management broker that had received an investment from Charterhouse Capital for $30 million in 2003 and was being sold for $655 million to New Mountain Capital. Oakleaf had achieved success through its asset-light business model. It operated by establishing waste management contracts with large national companies, then brokering out the local waste pickup to independently owned haulers. The company had successfully competed in a cutthroat industry for over a decade and built a network of over 2,500 haulers. While Oakleaf was successful in many ways, Morris and Spiegel believed its model was still inefficient because the company did not use a technology platform to optimize service, collect data, and align incentives. Morris hypothesized that the use of technology could transform the industry by further rationalizing the market, reducing landfill waste, and finding more customer savings through advanced logistics and analytics that would benefit both the waste customers and haulers (see **Exhibit 1**).

Early Days: Making Connections and Exploring Options

While at Princeton, Morris was reading Plutarch's "Life of Julius Caesar" at the same time that he was developing Rubicon's business model. The story of Caesar crossing the Rubicon River – a point of no return – was inspiring as he thought about the impact Rubicon wanted to make.

Rubicon Global was launched in 2008 as an experiment to test the concept of a virtual, integrated waste management company. Morris began talking to large customers while maxing out his credit cards to build the initial website and pay legal fees. Morris knew Rubicon would need to focus on completely understanding the customer's needs before scaling the technology. As Morris put it,

> We were focused on learning from the customers to make sure we could get adoption. People did not get why we were building the business this way, instead of focusing more on the technology. Most traditional tech companies aim to develop the technology first, and then build scale. We knew we had to get the offering right if we hoped to succeed in this market.

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Morris put to work long-standing friendships made in his home state of Kentucky. The first major customer breakthrough came after Morris reached out to Henry "Hank" Dudgeon, III, a successful real estate broker from Kentucky. Dudgeon introduced Morris to the CEO of a national pizza chain. In the meeting, Morris pitched a technology platform that would simplify contract management and invoicing while providing the customer with more transparency into where their waste went. Additionally, he pointed out various innovative ways that Rubicon could lower the company's trash bills through a better understanding of the components of the waste. For example, the pizza company could sell waste pizza dough to ethanol generators instead of paying to dispose of it. This unique approach to finding new uses for waste combined with Rubicon's simplified contract management software won the bid.

Though Morris walked out of the meeting with a contract, he knew that was the easy part. As he put it, "anyone can get the meeting or even a contract. After the deal is when 95% of the work has to be done to demonstrate what you can do." To help deliver on the bid, Dudgeon joined Morris and Spiegel as co-founder and Director of Business Development. The team set to work to deliver on the promises they had made. While the future vision was fully automated systems, the early technology required manual input. This meant the team had to directly develop and manage relationships with the waste haulers and recyclers. It also meant they had to manually input data for customer reports and invoices. This hands-on experience allowed the team to learn the customer needs in-depth and aided in prioritizing development of new software features.

Performing on the pizza chain contract opened the doors to other notable large customers such as 7-Eleven and Wegmans Grocery Stores. Each customer brought new challenges, but also new opportunities to demonstrate Rubicon's skills at waste reduction (see **Exhibit 2**). Rubicon worked with each customer to understand, categorize, and catalog streams of waste in a central database at an unprecedented level of detail. It then collaborated with companies that used the database to identify alternative uses for the waste streams. For example, Wegmans produced significant amounts of waste in the form of discarded uniforms. Using the database, an automotive insulation manufacturer identified the uniforms as potential material for trunk insulation, at which point Rubicon routed them to the manufacturer for a small fee. Not only did this divert the waste from the landfill for the customer, it also enabled sustainable growth for the recycling venture by providing a low-cost, consistent raw material input.

To build out the initial software to service these early customers, Rubicon raised $1 million from Lane Moore's venture fund, QuarterMoore Capital. A seasoned investor and entrepreneur, Moore offered to partner with Rubicon and prepare the business for scale. Moore had earlier co-founded a company that manufactured a "dumpster in a bag" known as Bagster, which he sold to Waste Management in 2009. In addition to seed capital, Moore brought to Rubicon the experience of building a disruptive venture in the highly concentrated waste industry.

Waste Management acquired Oakleaf in July 2011 for $425 million.[a,2] Waste Management planned to gain access to Oakleaf's existing customers and extensive independent hauler network. Essentially, Waste Management was buying waste volume to absorb into its landfill infrastructure, which was its profit center and primary driver for business. Some of Oakleaf's customers were concerned about the acquisition, given Waste Management's reputation. This concern helped Rubicon, which was now the only independent waste management player with both the capability to service a large national customer and a focus on sustainability.

[a] Waste Management's acquisition price for the majority of Oakleaf's assets equated to a 1.4x revenue and 5.3x EBITDA multiple.

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Through mutual connections, the Rubicon team was able to connect with Perry Moss around this same time. Moss was known as the "Michael Jordan of garbage" because he had sold and managed over $1 billion in waste contracts. A pioneer of the asset-light business model with over 20 years of experience, Moss was a key driver in Oakleaf's previous acquisition by New Mountain Capital in 2007.

As Rubicon grew, management planned to introduce a set of advanced software features, such as automation of hauler scheduling, invoicing, and metrics reporting. IBM and SAP had tried and failed to make inroads in this space. The traditional technology companies focused on building the technology first instead of looking at its application. Rubicon intended to hire crucial talent for technology development. In February 2012, Rubicon raised a $5 million Series-A round that was led by Peter Kellner of Richmond Global, a venture capital firm. A number of prominent investors with strategic ties also invested, including Bill Gatton (renowned entrepreneur and namesake of the University of Kentucky's Business School), Rotunda Capital Partners (logistics and distribution PE firm), and the Brown Forman Family office (owners of Jack Daniels and Korbel).

By spring of 2014, Rubicon had proven its original thesis and was serving 22,000 customer locations through a network of 10,000 haulers and waste processors. The team consisted of an experienced management team and advisory board (see **Exhibit 3**). Rubicon had reached a size that it was able to enter into final negotiations for a contract with one of the largest retailers in the world.

In late 2014, Michael Anders the Co-founder of ICONIQ Capital introduced Morris to Oscar Salazar, one of the founders of Uber. After Salazar learned about Rubicon's model, he told Morris, "Rubicon could be bigger than Uber." This was a defining point for Rubicon in thinking about the trajectory of the company.

Waste: Everyone's Problem

Waste has been one of the world's biggest environmental issues since the beginning of time. While dumping material into a landfill has always been the easiest solution, the Romans knew this was not the best use of resources. Instead, the Romans developed early recycling methods for material such as glass, bronze, and pottery.[3]

In 2013, garbage production, collection, and processing reached record-highs in the United States. Most garbage ended up in landfills because it was unprofitable to recycle or the materials simply had not been sorted properly.[b] Only 34% of garbage was recycled; disposed waste still contained significant amounts of recyclable materials (see **Exhibits 4a** and **4b** for garbage trends and composition).

Many citizens, politicians, and business leaders were concerned about low recycling rates and other indicators of poor environmental stewardship. There was mounting evidence of human impact on the global climate.[4] Sustainability and social impact had become top issues, and recent data revealed that companies with high Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) ratings outperformed their peers.[5] Morris believed this shift towards sustainability would have a profound impact on the waste management industry. He knew Rubicon's mission of promoting sustainability through diverting waste from landfills would be key in attracting the right investors, employees, and customers to the company.

[b] The economics of recycling were determined by several factors: access to readily recyclable wastes, difficulty of extracting raw materials, market value of the resulting raw material, and comparable costs of alternatives such as landfill disposal.

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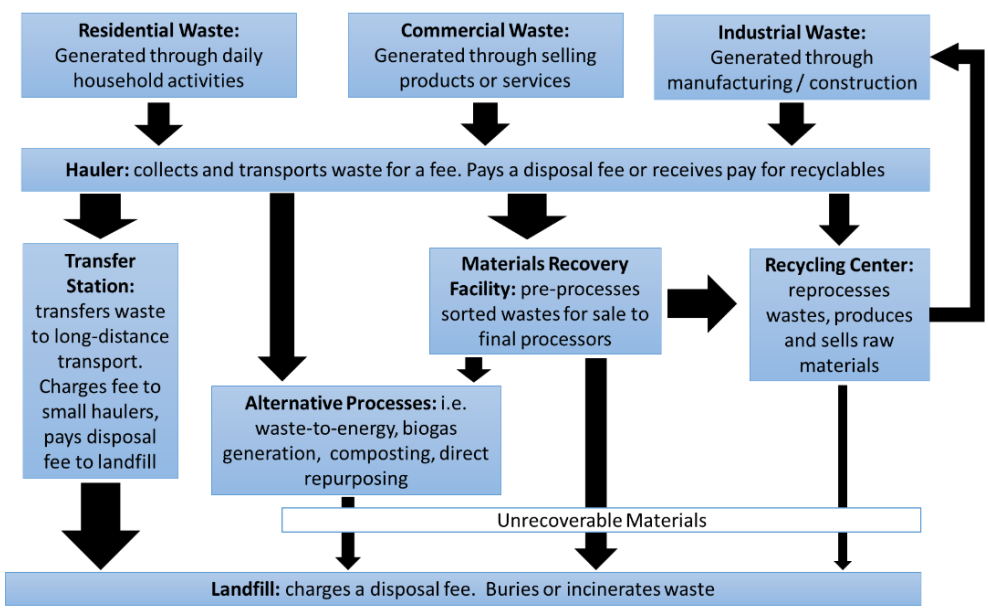
As part of their commitment to sustainability, Rubicon completed B Corporation certification in 2012. Certified B Corporation status was issued by B Lab, a nonprofit aimed at solving social and environmental problems by monitoring sustainable businesses, lobbying for legislation, and providing data and analytical tools to help businesses improve their impact (see **Exhibit 5a** for more information on B Corporations).

Maintaining B Corp status required a small annual fee, bi-annual recertification, and filing of an annual sustainability report, the results of which were publicly available. There were several benefits to the certification, most significant perhaps being assurance to investors and customers of the company's adherence to its mission. B Lab had certified 950 companies across over 30 countries by 2014, and in obtaining this certification Rubicon joined a lineup of notable mission-driven companies such as Patagonia, Seventh Generation, and Sungevity (see **Exhibit 5b**).[6]

The Waste Management Industry

At least 11 billion tons of solid waste was collected globally in 2013, 780 million tons of which was generated in the United States alone.[c,7,8] The waste management industry was broadly tasked with collecting, processing, and disposing of these materials. As **Figure 1** shows, competing in this industry required navigating a complex landscape of players responsible for moving wastes across full material lifecycles (see **Exhibit 6a** for definitions of each player).

Figure 1 U.S. Waste Management Process



Source: Casewriter.

[c] Solid wastes were broadly defined as all refuse resulting from residential, commercial, and industrial activities. The most common externally managed waste was Municipal Solid Waste (MSW), often simply called trash or garbage.

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Waste Management Customers

There were three primary customer segments for waste services: residential, commercial, and industrial. The nature of waste removal contracts and composition of wastes varied significantly across the three.

Residential customers generated waste through the course of daily activities and accounted for the majority of waste in landfills. Though the average American generated over four pounds of trash per day, waste was not a front-of-mind issue for most Americans. The ubiquitous, efficient system of curbside collection worked well for most people. Depending on the municipality, these services were arranged either directly by the municipality and paid by local taxes or through individual contracts with a waste management company.[d]

Commercial customers generated waste in the course of selling products or services. The largest components in this category were bulk packaging materials and organic wastes.[e] Both small-to-medium enterprises (SMEs) and large corporations had limitations in their options for waste management providers. Most SMEs (e.g. local restaurants, auto repair shops, small retailers) worked with local contractors. Larger multi-location companies (e.g. national retailers, restaurant chains) preferred to work with waste management companies that could service all locations through a single contract.

Industrial customers included product manufacturers and construction and demolition companies.[f] As with commercial customers, many had contracts for regular waste removal. A key difference between commercial and industrial customers was the higher use of as-needed services, such as a dumpster rental for debris collection at a construction or demolition site. Industrial companies were also the end customer for recycled wastes as it reentered the production cycle as raw material.

Market Structure

The U.S. waste management industry generated $64 billion in annual revenues in 2013. Waste Management and Republic Services, companies that had actively consolidated the industry over several decades, controlled over 35% of the market (see **Exhibit 6b**). Approximately 18,000 smaller players had to compete with these national-scale companies on cost of service, quality, and coverage. These smaller companies tended to focus on and compete for a single task in the value chain over a limited geographic basis.

Waste management companies provided regular services to commercial and industrial customers as well as municipalities on a contract basis. One-time or off-cycle services (i.e. a one-time debris pickup at a construction site) were billed at the time services were rendered. While small players could directly service national companies or municipalities, it was typically through subcontracts

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[d] There were two types of Municipal Solid Waste markets in 2014: franchised and free-market. In franchised markets, waste management companies would bid on exclusive rights to service different zones and the governing municipality directly managed the contract. In free markets, municipalities set the rules and companies then formed contracts directly with individual businesses and residences.

[e] Organic wastes were non-hazardous materials such as expired produce at a grocery store or leftover food at a restaurant.

[f] The total industrial waste category was massive: EPA estimated over 7 billion tons generated in the US in 2013. However, large industrial waste producers directly managed their own recycling or disposal. Externally managed industrial wastes represented approximately 530 million tons, generated primarily by construction, demolition, and small manufactures.

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with large waste management companies that held the account.[g] Small service providers had limited transparency or bargaining power with large waste management companies.

To provide comprehensive services and reduce costs across the full lifecycle of waste, the largest companies had invested heavily in vertical integration. They owned, managed, or subcontracted large fleets of trucks, recycling facilities, transfer facilities, and landfills. As a result, they had significant operating assets on their balance sheets, the largest of category of which was landfills (see **Exhibit 7** for Waste Management's financial statements as an example).

While landfills were capital intensive, they had attractive lifetime return profiles because of relatively low operating costs and attractive pricing. Landfill and transfer station operations together represented over 30% of the EBIT for the largest large waste management companies (see **Exhibit 8**). Integrated waste management companies had strong incentives to send collected wastes to landfills rather than finding lower-margin or more environmentally friendly alternatives.[h]

Rubicon's Business Model

By 2014, the so-called Sharing Economy had disrupted traditional service industries like transportation and hospitality. Successful Sharing Economy companies like Uber and Airbnb were using technology to align consumers and service providers, improve distribution, and reduce costs and capital requirements (see **Exhibit 9**). Rubicon Global positioned itself to disrupt the waste industry in the same manner. They created virtual capabilities in each waste management domain that could rapidly scale to meet the needs of new customers or geographies.

Rubicon operated as a multi-sided platform, bringing together at least four separate groups: customers who wanted to get rid of waste, recyclers, haulers, and landfills (see **Exhibit 10**). Rubicon chose not to own any hard assets. They could connect customers and vendors on a cloud-based platform, providing value to each. They used software to solve each player's problem. Customers wanted efficiency, transparency, lower costs, and, in many cases, a more environmentally responsible approach to waste management (see **Exhibit 11)**. Recyclers wanted access to items that they could transform at a profit. Haulers wanted access to national contracts, better logistical support, and new ways to compete with the dominant industry players. Landfill operators needed more tonnage.

Rubicon used software and analytics to create shared value for each party. Rubicon's model was radically different from that of Waste Management and Republic in that it did not create incentives that would favor any particular service supplier. Rubicon benefitted from diverting waste from landfills rather than having a business model dependent on landfill tonnage. Rubicon's model was positioned to bring a traditionally archaic, legacy-controlled industry into the 21st century.

Rubicon billed customers on an annual subscription basis. Rubicon had three primary sources revenue: a fee that was based on the composition and amount of waste; a management fee for specialized software services (invoicing, data reporting, etc.); and, a diversion bonus based on the amount of tonnage hauled that did not go to a landfill. Contracts with large customers were typically for two or three year periods.

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[g] Large waste companies controlled multi-year national or regional contracts, but often did not have operating assets or capacity within range of every customer location. Independent service providers were subtracted for these locations.

[h] For example, Waste Management minimum IRR for collection and landfill projects was 12%, while recycling projects required 15%. Source: Waste Management investor presentation, September 23, 2010, pg. 22.

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To illustrate (see **Exhibit 12**), a large customer with 1,700 locations would have paid $10 million per year in traditional hauling costs. Rubicon would typically find recycling solutions where other haulers might have simply delivered to the landfill. This meant that instead of having to pay disposal fees for each ton of waste removed, Rubicon found an average recycling value of $96 per ton. The result was that Rubicon would save this customer 20% on waste fees and split the savings 50/50.

Poised for Growth

By 2014, Rubicon had built an impressive lineup of customers and demonstrated the ability to service large national accounts. In the process, the team had validated the business model and developed many of the core technologies in their capabilities roadmap (see **Exhibit 13)**. The company had the potential to service new national clients across multiple industries (see **Exhibit 14** for number of locations per customer type). The efficiency of Rubicon's technology-centric business had allowed them to triple the number of serviced locations from 7,000 to 22,000 over the past three years without having to materially increase headcount.

Technology was at the core of Rubicon's strategic positioning. The company had been investing heavily in new capabilities and had built an internal R&D team, called "Rubicon X". One exciting technology in development was a sensor that would remotely monitor dumpsters to automatically alert haulers of the need for a pickup. Another product was a mobile app for on-demand waste pickup calls. Through this app, customers would have the ability to line up haulers as needed, in a manner similar to arranging transportation on Uber.

Rubicon had gotten traction with large customers but had modest penetration of the Small and Medium Enterprise (SME) segment, which most large waste management providers had previously considered too costly to reach and serve. However, given that there were over 6 million total SME locations in the U.S., this represented a major opportunity.[i] As Rubicon continued to increase the density of their hauler and processor network and improve the flexibility of their technology offerings, servicing these accounts had steadily become more realistic. In particular, the on-demand app service would enable serving new customers of all sizes without concern for how many locations the customer owned. However, SME customers would likely not sign the same multi-year contracts as large companies. The effect this would have on customer churn and lifetime customer value was yet to be determined.

Rubicon also had the possibility of competing for municipal waste contracts, a $12 billion market. As Phil Rodoni, Rubicon's Chief Technology Officer put it:

> The residential market is the logical next step as we roll out our on-demand service capabilities. Transforming waste into an asset and offering on-demand services are equally important opportunities for residential customers as they are for businesses. We think Rubicon is best positioned to increase choice and service options in the residential market.

Finally, there were additional market opportunities outside of MSW, like hazardous wastes. The EPA estimated that 5,600 facilities in 280 industries (e.g. specialty chemicals) generated or recycled hazardous secondary materials classified as solid waste.[9] Healthcare and medical waste alone

[i] As of the 2012 census, there were over 5.7 million companies in the Unites States: 5.1 million small companies mostly having a single location; 580,000 medium size companies with an average of 1.8 locations each; over 18,000 large companies with an average of 66 locations each, the largest of which had thousands of locations.

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represented a $3 billion market. Rubicon could leverage its technology platform to go after these markets as well.

Rubicon's management now faced an age-old dilemma: focus on the existing customer segment or aggressively pursue multiple markets. Focus on the national businesses would require continued investment in technology, network building, and customer acquisition. If the company were to expand its vision, they would need significantly more capital to go after residential, SME, and industrial segments.

Sizing the Round, Choosing Investors

The Rubicon team was heading into their next round of fundraising at a favorable time. The venture capital market had fully recovered from the dot-com boom and bust of 2000. The question was no longer if Rubicon could raise money, but rather how much and from whom?

Cloud-based business models such as Rubicon's typically carried higher valuations than their asset-heavy counterparts. These companies could scale rapidly with modest capital requirements. As an example, the logistics and freight industry had gone through a similar technology disruption over the recent decade. The asset-light logistics companies continued to carry higher valuations than their asset-heavy predecessors (see **Exhibit 15** for comparable company data).

Morris and the leadership team had critical decisions to make about the pace at which they scaled. They could invest less rapidly and achieve profitability quicker. Alternatively, they could hire aggressively, build out the technology platform, and pursue multiple market opportunities simultaneously. The on-demand scheduling app alone would likely take a year to develop from the time the round closed.

A variety of investors had become interested in Rubicon due to recent media coverage. Many of these investors had the deep pockets that would be necessary to enable the company to grow, but Morris was unsure how they fit with Rubicon's environmental and social mission. As with previous backers, investors in this new round needed to bring something of value to the table for Rubicon. As Morris saw it, an investor was not just providing capital; they were joining the team. Many investors focused their due diligence on market size and profitability rates, while others focused on how they could support the company's mission. Morris felt this alignment had made a tangible difference in the support of early investors in building Rubicon. Morris and Moore reflected on how much the team had accomplished since the company was started. Each year, they had become even more convinced of the potential for socially positive disruption. They knew raising capital would help, but execution would ultimately determine if Rubicon would have the impact they envisioned.

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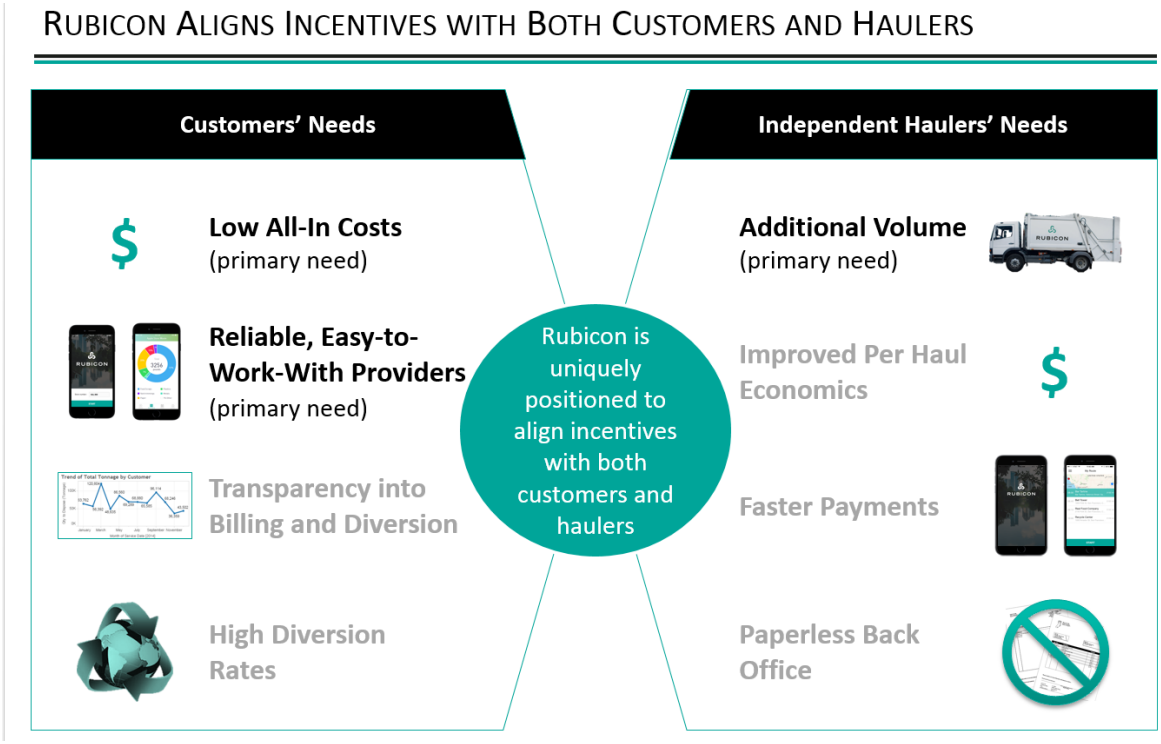
Exhibit 1 Rubicon Value Proposition



Source: Company documents.

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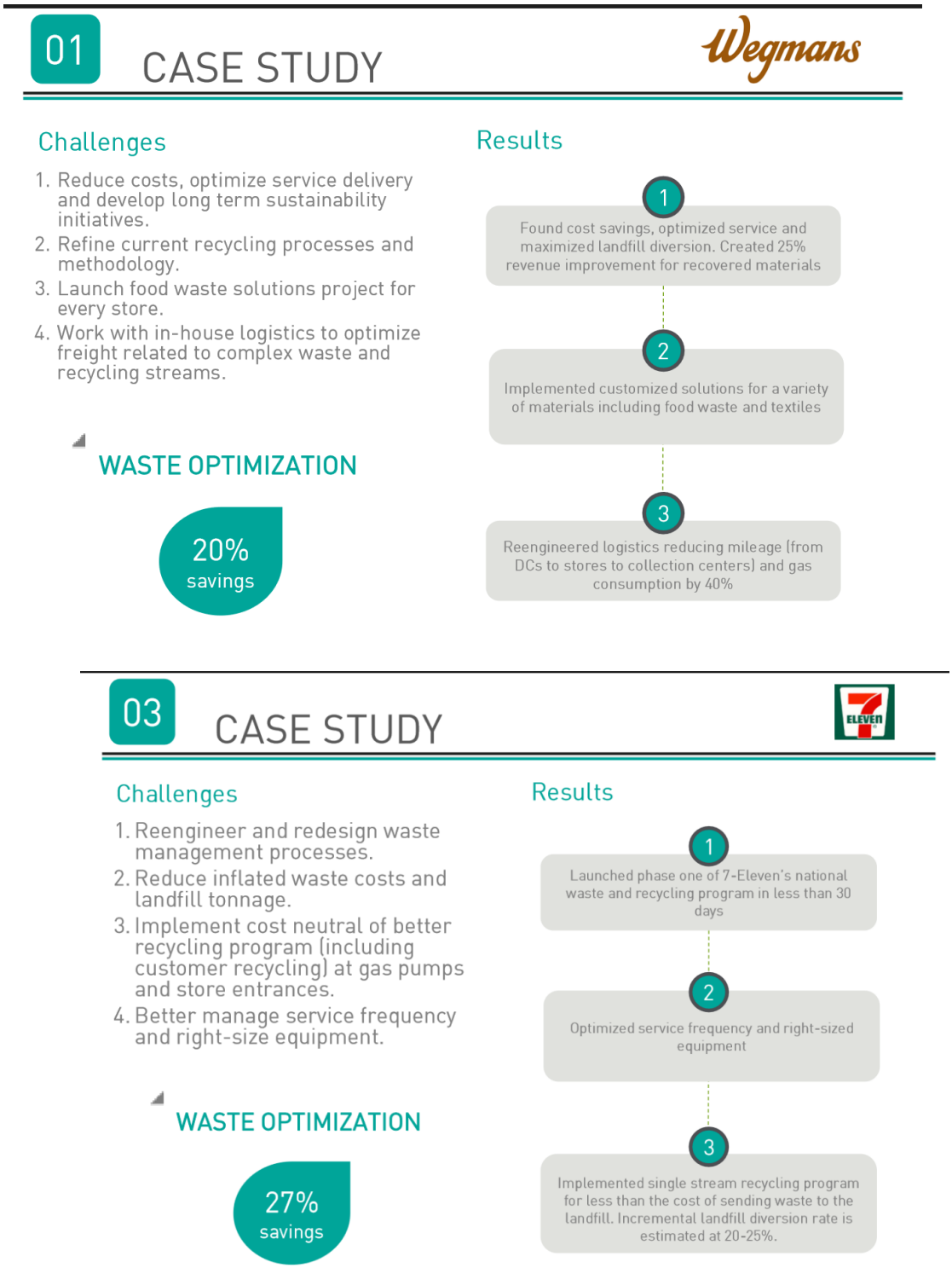
Exhibit 2 Solving Unique Customer Needs



Source: Company documents.

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Exhibit 3a Management Team

	Prior Experience	Rubicon Tenure	Years in Industry
Lane Moore *Co-founder & Executive Chairman*	WM BAGSTER; PODS The Best Moving & Storage Idea Ever.; QuarterMoore; Stephens	6+ years	9 years
Nate Morris *Co-founder & Chief Executive Officer*	ThinkKentucky.com; World Economic Forum; Young Global Leaders; 40; Princeton	6+ years	6+ years
Perry Moss *President*	Oakleaf Intelligent Waste Management; SMURFIT-STONE solving it from all sides; Champion Champion International Corporation	4 years	24 years
John Bax *Chief Financial Officer*	Walmart; livingsocial; RecycleBank; EY; State University	1 month	1 month
Phil Rodoni *Chief Technology Officer*	esurance an Allstate company; TRAVELZOO; charles SCHWAB; Seer; Berkeley University of California	2 months	2 months
Mary Trenchard *VP Customer Advocacy*	Bigbelly Change Your Space; WM Waste Management; Oakleaf Intelligent Waste Management; pitney bowes	1 year	6 years
Felix Faulhaber *VP Data, Analytics & Insights*	Coca-Cola; McKinsey&Company; SIEMENS; AIRBUS	7 months	7 months
Joey Hardison *VP of Operations*	McKinsey&Company; ExxonMobil; HBS; GT	New hire	5 years
Keith Laabs *VP of Strategy & Program Management*	McKinsey&Company; BAIN & COMPANY; Coca-Cola; S Business;	New hire	4 months

Advisors and Investors

Marc Benioff *Investor*	salesforce; ORACLE; Apple; USC	· Founder, Chairman and CEO, Salesforce
Barry Sternlicht *Investor*	Starwood Capital Group; starwood Hotels and Resorts; HBS;	· Chairman and CEO, Starwood Capital Group · Founder and former CEO, Starwood Hotels
Andrew Jassy *Investor*	amazon; amazon web services; HBS;	· SVP Web Services, Amazon · VP Associates and Web Services, Amazon
Jack Oliver *Investor*	BRYAN CAVE; BUSH CHENEY '04;	· Senior Policy Advisor, Bryan Cave · National Finance Vice-Chairman, Bush-Cheney '04 · Deputy Chairman, Republican National Committee
Oscar Salazar *Investor, Advisor*	UBER; ride; pager; CITIVOX	· Chief Technology and Product Officer, Ride · Co-Founder & CTO, Uber
David Plouffe *Advisor*	UBER; Obama Biden; DCCC	· SVP Strategy & Policy, Uber · Senior Advisor to President Obama · Campaign Manager, Obama for America
Brent Callinicos *Director*	UBER; Google; Microsoft;	· CFO, Uber · VP, Treasurer and Chief Accountant, Google · CFO, Platforms and Services, Microsoft
Peter Kellner *Director*	Richmond Global; endeavor; World Economic Forum; Young Global Leaders; HBS; Princeton	· Founder/Managing Partner, Richmond Global · Co-Founder, Endeavor Global
Dr. Joel Moxley *Director*	FORO Energy; North Bridge; PriorSmart; MIT; Princeton	· Founder, FORO Energy · Former EIR, North Bridge Venture Partners · Co-Founder, PriorSmart
John Gardner *Director*	LearnVest; Northwestern Mutual; CABEZON	· Co-Founder and CFO, LearnVest (acquired by Northwestern Mutual in April 2015) · Founding Partner and COO, Cabezon Capital

Source: Company documents.

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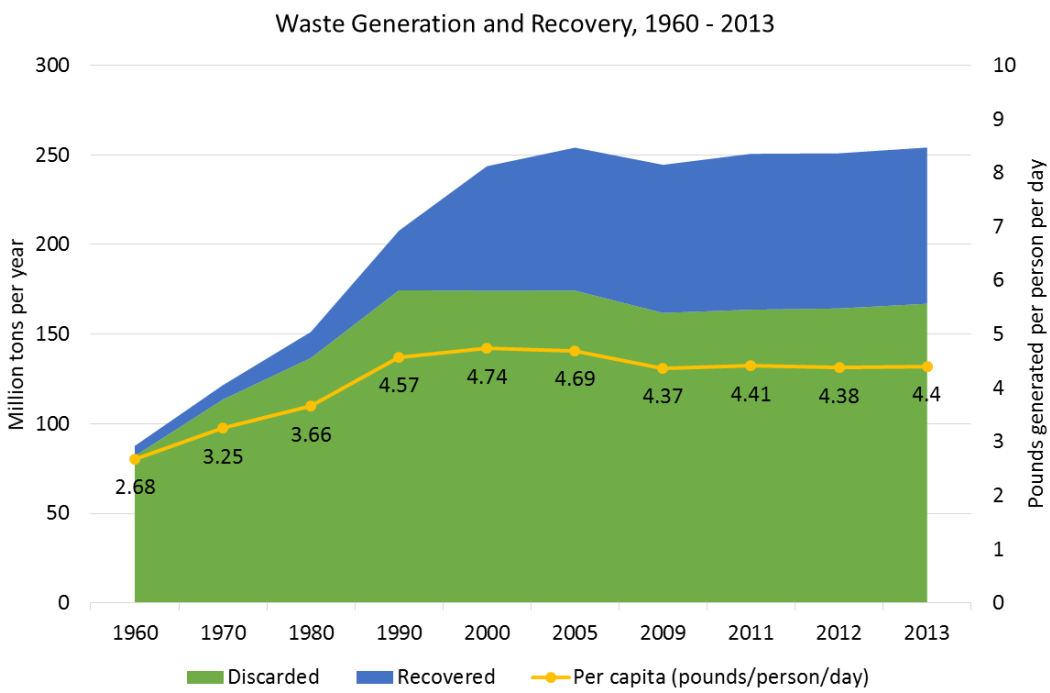
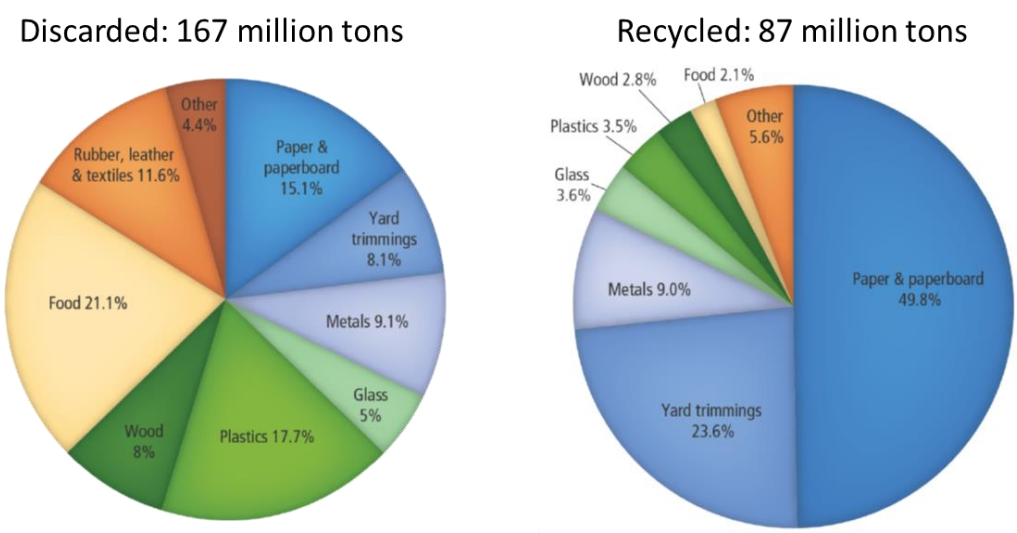
Exhibit 4a Trash Generation and Recovery Trends



Source: epa.gov, Advancing Sustainable Materials Management: Fact and Figures 2013, Assessing Trends in Material Generation, Recycling and Disposal in the United States, June 2015.

Note: Figures 4a and 4b consist of waste produced through consumer activities. Sources are approximately 60% residential, 40% commercial. Does not include hazardous or industrial (pre-consumer) waste.

Exhibit 4b Trash Compositions: Recovered and Disposed



Source: epa.gov, Advancing Sustainable Materials Management: Fact and Figures 2013, Assessing Trends in Material Generation, Recycling and Disposal in the United States, June 2015.

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Exhibit 5a B-corporation vs Benefit Corporation

Certified B Corp vs. Benefit Corp: What's the Difference?

What?	Certified B Corporation	Benefit Corporation	Same or Different?
Accountability	Directors required to consider effects of decisions on shareholders *and* stakeholders	Directors required to consider effects of decisions on shareholders *and* stakeholders	**Same**
Transparency	Must publish a report assessing their overall social/environmental performance against a third party standard	Must publish publicly a report assessing their overall social/environmental performance against a third party standard	**Same**
Performance	Must achieve a verified minimum score on the B Impact Assessment	Report is not required to be verified, certified or audited	**Different**
Support	Can access portfolio of services and support from B Lab (marketing, raising money, etc.)	--	**Different**
Availability	Available in all 50 states and around the world	Legally recognized by 7 states	**Different**

the change we seek™ B Corporations - Public Policy - Impact Investing

Source: Provided by B Lab, https://www.bcorporation.net/, accessed August 2015.

Exhibit 5b Notable Registered B-Corporations

Source: http://rubiconglobal.com/company/certified-b-corporation/, accessed August 2015.

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Exhibit 6a Waste Management Industry Players

Haulers provide waste collection services for garbage and construction debris from customer sites. They are paid for services through regularly scheduled collection contracts or for as-needed services. Expenses for haulers are mainly fuel, disposal fees, labor, and vehicle maintenance and the primary operating assets are equipment related to hauling such as trucks and dumpsters. Since fuel is a significant operating expense, haulers prefer to collect and dispose of as much waste as possible while driving the shortest distances possible. Despite this, haulers often do not have sophisticated routing or logistics tools at their disposal, nor do they have access to customer waste data necessary for these tools.

Transfer Stations aggregate waste from smaller haulers for transport over longer distances using lower-cost bulk transport systems (cargo truck, rail, or barge). The expenses for these facilities are transport fees for aggregated wastes, facility operations, and final disposal costs. Transfer facilities make money by charging a disposal fee that depends on the type of waste, since that dictates transport distance and final disposal fee.

Materials Recovery Facilities (MRFs) are similar in function to Transfer Stations; they sort, crush, and grind recyclable materials, which are then sold to recycling or alternate processors facilities.

Landfills are the final destination for the majority of solid wastes. Due to the significant capital investments required for new landfills, the majority are owned or managed by the largest waste management companies, with only a small percent operating as standalone entities. Almost all landfill revenue come from disposal fees.

Recycling centers are specialized processors that convert recyclable waste into raw input materials for industrial production—paper, metal, glass, and plastic. These facilities require complicated and costly equipment. Profitability is highly dependent on global raw materials pricing.

Diversion Alternative are niche or nascent opportunities outside of traditional recycling or landfills. A significant challenge is that entities with an alternate use for a waste and the entities producing said waste are often unaware of each other. The economics of alternative processes for each player heavily depend on the maturity of the market. For example, before biodiesel gained popularity in the U.S. restaurants freely gave away their used cooking oils because their alternative was to pay a disposal fee. As biodiesel processors grew and began to compete, restaurants found they could charge a small fee for the oils. This shifted the economics for both the biodiesel processors and end customers who had purchased the fuels as cheaper alternative to diesel derived from fossil fuels.

Recyclable Materials Wholesalers[j] source or receive materials for delivery to MRFs, source processed materials for sale to downstream manufacturers, and export materials both intra- and internationally. An example of a typical wholesale operation is a scrap yard, which receives large metal scraps ranging from wrecked automobiles to C&D debris. The scrap yard separates the materials, sells what is directly reusable (such as used auto parts) to distributors or consumers, sells the recyclable materials to an MRF, and disposes of the remainder in a landfill. Challenges in this market are low margins on materials, moderate capital intensity for holding and sorting material, and inefficiencies in sourcing and selling higher-value materials.[10]

[j] Recycled materials wholesaling was a tangential industry and not a primary activity of the waste management industry, thus was not typically included in waste management and recycling market sizes. However, this was a $99 billion industry whose players were responsible for moving significant volumes of material across the waste management value chain.

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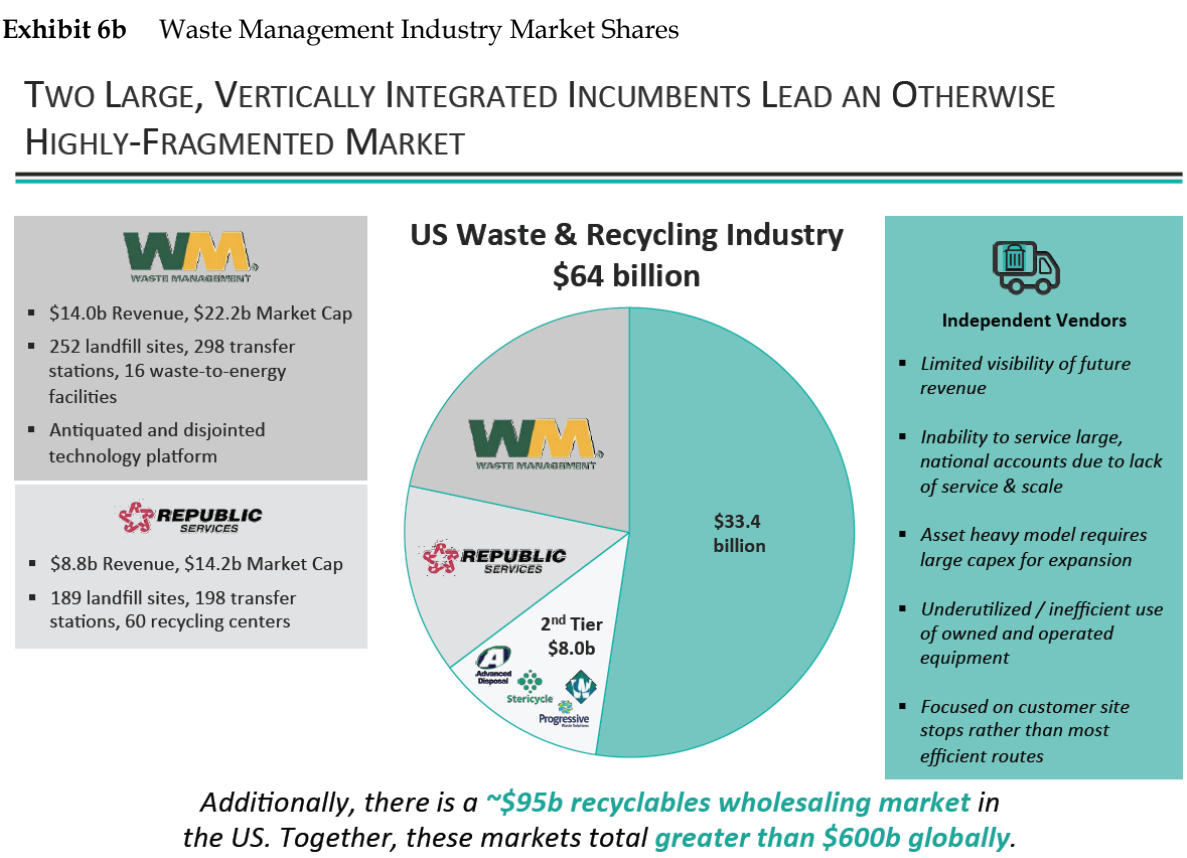
Exhibit 6b Waste Management Industry Market Shares



Source: Company documents: IBIS World, First Research; Waste Business Journal.

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Exhibit 7 Waste Management Income Statement and Balance Sheet

Income Statement

Fiscal Period Ending:	Dec-31-2012	Dec-31-2013
Revenues		
Collection:		
Commercial	3,417	3,423
Residential	2,584	2,608
Industrial	2,129	2,209
Other	275	273
Landfill	2,685	2,790
Transfer	1,296	1,329
Wheelabrator[1]	846	845
Recycling	1,360	1,447
Other	1,416	1,583
Intercompany	(2,359)	(2,524)
Total Revenue	**13,649.0**	**13,983.0**
Operating Expenses		
Labor and related benefits	2,407	2,506
Transfer and disposal costs	964	973
Maintenance and repairs	1,157	1,181
Subcontractor costs	1,190	1,182
Cost of goods sold	919	1,000
Fuel	649	603
Disposal and franchise fees and taxes	630	653
Landfill operating costs	224	232
Risk management	230	244
Other	509	538
Total Operating Expenses	**8,879.0**	**9,112.0**
Gross Profit	**4,770.0**	**4,871.0**
Selling General & Admin Exp.	1,472.0	1,468.0
Depreciation & Amort.	1,297.0	1,333.0
Impairment of Oil, Gas & Mineral Property	0	15.0
Operating Income	**2,001.0**	**2,055.0**
Non-operating Expenses[2]	(698.0)	(1,561.0)
Income Tax Expense	443.0	364.0
Net Income to Company	**860**	**130**

Balance Sheet

As of:	12/31/2012	12/31/2013
Assets		
Cash And Equivalents	194	58
Short Term Investments		177
Accounts Receivable	1,737	1,699
Other Receivables	102	111
Inventory	174	178
Deferred Tax Assets, Curr.	76	113
Other Current Assets	140	163
Total Current Assets	2,423	2,499

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Exhibit 7 (continued)

Property, Plant & Equipment:		
Land	657	636
Landfills	13,266	13,416
Vehicles	3,954	4,115
Machinery and equipment	3,967	3,888
Containers	2,482	2,449
Buildings and improvements	3,514	3,594
Furniture, fixtures and office equipment	923	969
Less accumulated depreciation on tangible property and equipment	(8,924)	(9,205)
Less accumulated landfill airspace amortization	(7,188)	(7,518)
Net Property, Plant & Equipment	12,651.0	12,344.0
Long-term Investments	667	414
Goodwill	6,291	6,070
Other Intangibles	397	529
Other Long-Term Assets	668	747
Total Assets	**23,097**	**22,603**
Liabilities		
Accounts Payable	842	744
Accrued Exp.	834	888
Curr. Port. of LT Debt	743	754
Unearned Revenue, Current	465	475
Other Current Liabilities	152	153
Total Current Liabilities	3,036	3,014
Long-Term Debt	9,215	9,500
Def. Tax Liability, Non-Curr.	1,947	1,842
Other Non-Current Liabilities	2,224	2,245
Total Liabilities	**16,422**	**16,601**
Total Equity	6,675	6,002
Total Liabilities And Equity	**23,097**	**22,603**

1 Wheelabrator is Waste Management's waste-to-energy subsidiary

2 Non-operating expenses consist of loss from affiliates, currency exchange loss, restructuring charges, goodwill impairment, loss or writedowns on sales of investments or assets, and legal settlements

Sources: Capital IQ, Company SEC filings, and casewriter calculations.

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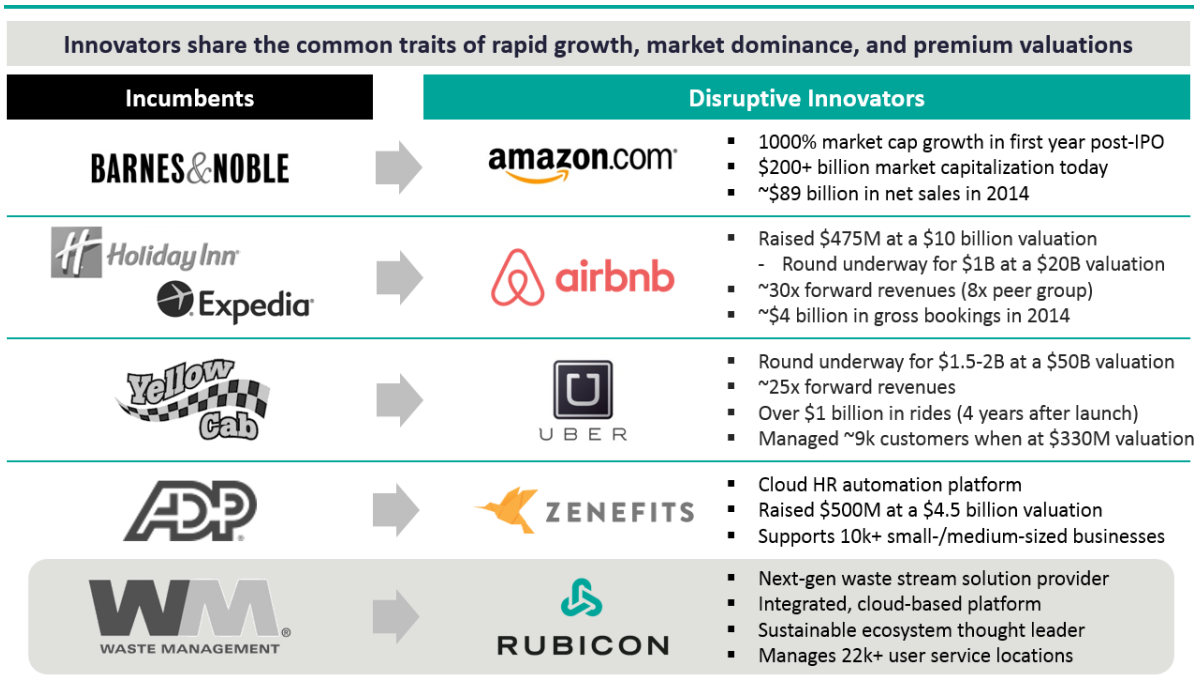
Exhibit 8 Landfill and Transfer EBIT Contribution for Major Waste Management Companies (2012)

	Progressive Waste Soln.	Republic Services	Waste Connections	Waste Management
Collection ($mm)	$1,354	$6,172	$1,069	$8,405
Transfer and Disposal ($mm)	$608	$978	$510	$1,296
Landfill ($mm)		$1,868		$2,685
Recycling & Other ($mm)	$134	$579	$145	$3,622
Intercompany[1] ($mm)	($256)	($1,404)	($219)	($2,359)
Total (incl. intercompany) ($mm)	$1,840	$8,193	$1,505	$13,649
Total (excl. intercompany) ($mm)	$2,096	$9,596	$1,724	$16,008
Landfill Revenue Net Basis	$304	$1,021	$255	$1,436
Transfer and Disposal Net Basis		$1,466		$538
Landfill + Transfer EBIT (estimated)	$91	$555	$100	$628
Total EBIT ($mm)	$269	$1,581	$321	$2,028
Landfill/Transfer EBIT as % of total	**34%**	**35%**	**31%**	**31%**

Source: Adapted from Credit Suisse Equity Research, "Waste Management Companies Can Become REITs," January 28, 2013, pg. 5. Accessed through Thompson ONE Research, August 2015.

Exhibit 9 Examples of Asset-Light Businesses Disrupting Asset-Heavy Industries



Source: Company documents; Capital IQ.

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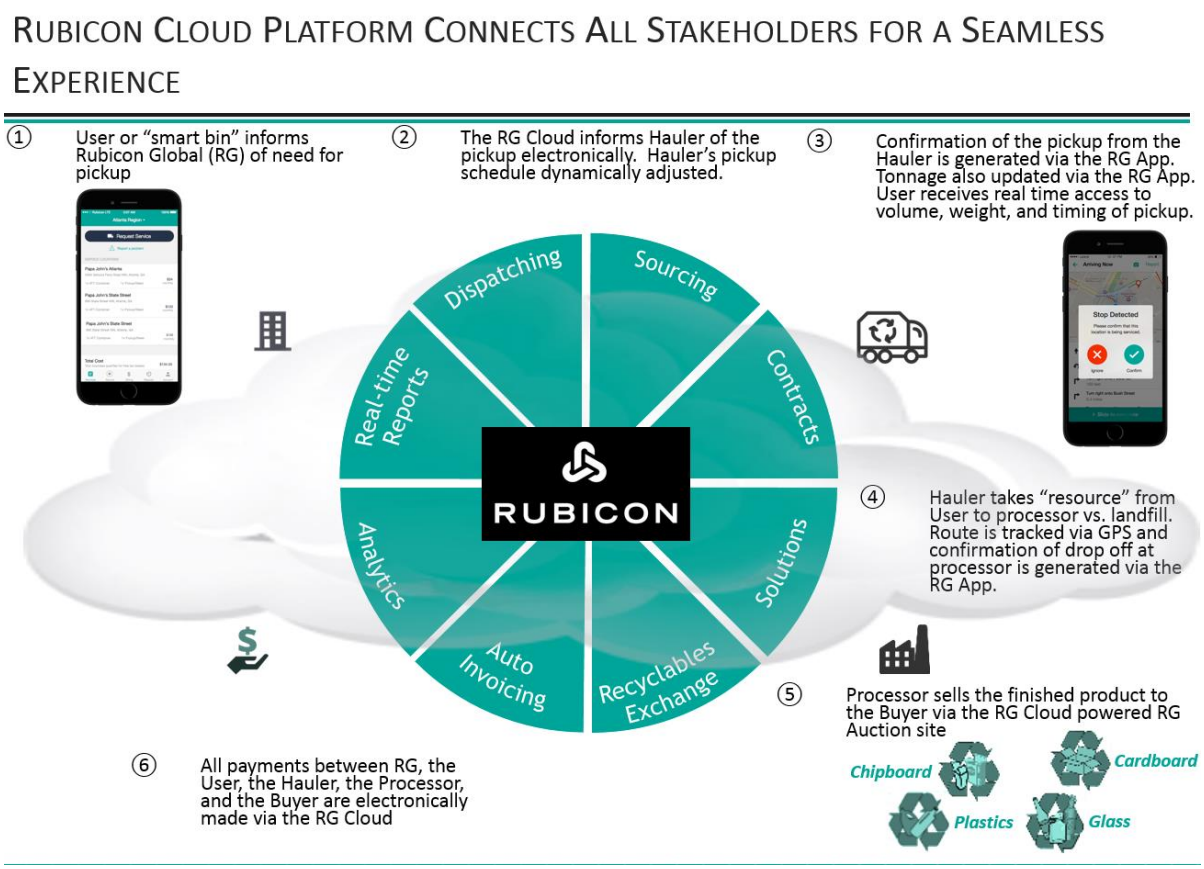
Exhibit 10 Rubicon Integration across the Waste Ecosystem



Source: Company documents.

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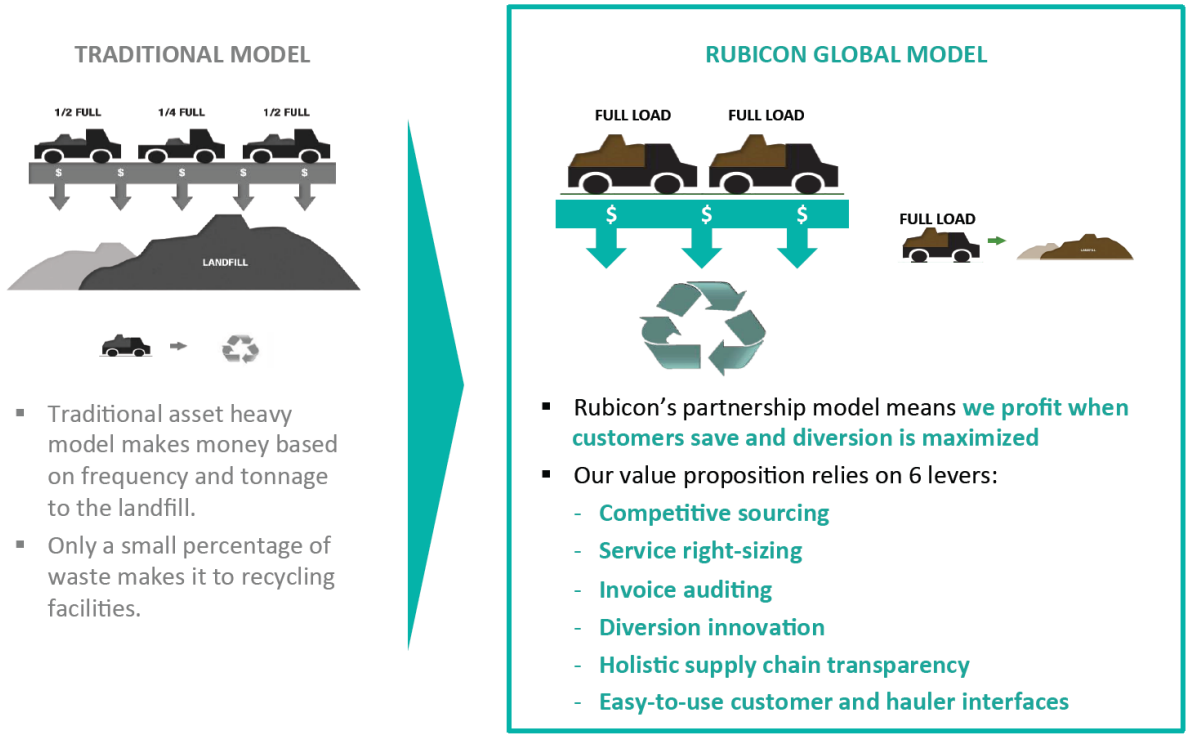
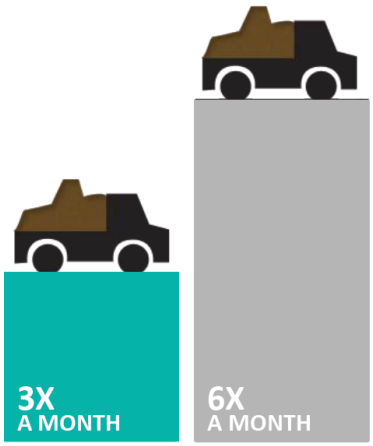
Exhibit 11 Hauling: Before and After Rubicon



Rubicon Global places a bid for $100 per haul and the traditional waste company places a bid at $100 per haul

When the customer is serviced:

- Rubicon Global rightsizes number of hauls to 3 x month at $100 per haul
- The traditional waste company does 6 x month at $100 (½ or ¼ hauls) per haul



Total Cost:

- Rubicon Global: $300/month
- Traditional waste company $600/month

Optimized Frequency = Lower Total Cost

Source: Company documents.

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Exhibit 12 Example Rubicon Customer Contribution and Margin

XYZ Retail Store Chain

# of customer locations:		1,700
Rubicon Monthly Subscription Fee ($/location)	$	14
Rubicon Monthly Management Fee ($/location)	$	30
Rubicon Landfill Diversion Bonus ($/ton)	$	15
Average Recycler Selling Price ($/ton)	$	96
Tons Diverted from Landfills **		30,000
Rubicon Savings Share		50%
Baseline (hauler pricing before Rubicon) **	$	10,000,000
Rubicon Hauler Pricing **	$	7,600,000

		Rubicon Revenue	**Customer Net Savings**
Rubicon Subscription Fee	($14 x 1,700) x 12	280,500	(280,500)
Rubicon Gainshare (50/50)	(10,000,000-7,600,000)x50%	1,200,000	1,200,000
Rubicon Management Fee	($30 x 1,700) x 12	612,000	(612,000)
Diverted tonnage sold to recyclers	30,000 x $96	-	2,880,000
Rubicon Diversion Bonus	30,000 x $15	450,000	(450,000)
		2,542,500	**2,737,500**

**** Based on annual transactions**

XYZ Retail Contribution to Rubicon

Bookings		
Hauler Service Bookings	7,600,000	
Recycler Bookings	2,880,000	
Rubicon Subscription Fee	280,500	
Rubicon Management Fee	612,000	
Rubicon Savings Share	1,200,000	
Total Bookings from XYZ	12,572,500	
Expenses		
Hauler Expense	7,600,000	
Recycler Net Expense (paid to customer)	2,430,000	*Reduced by Rubicon Diversion Bonus
Total Expenses	10,030,000	
Rubicon Net Revenue from XYZ	2,542,500	
Operating Margin	**20%**	

Source: Company documents.

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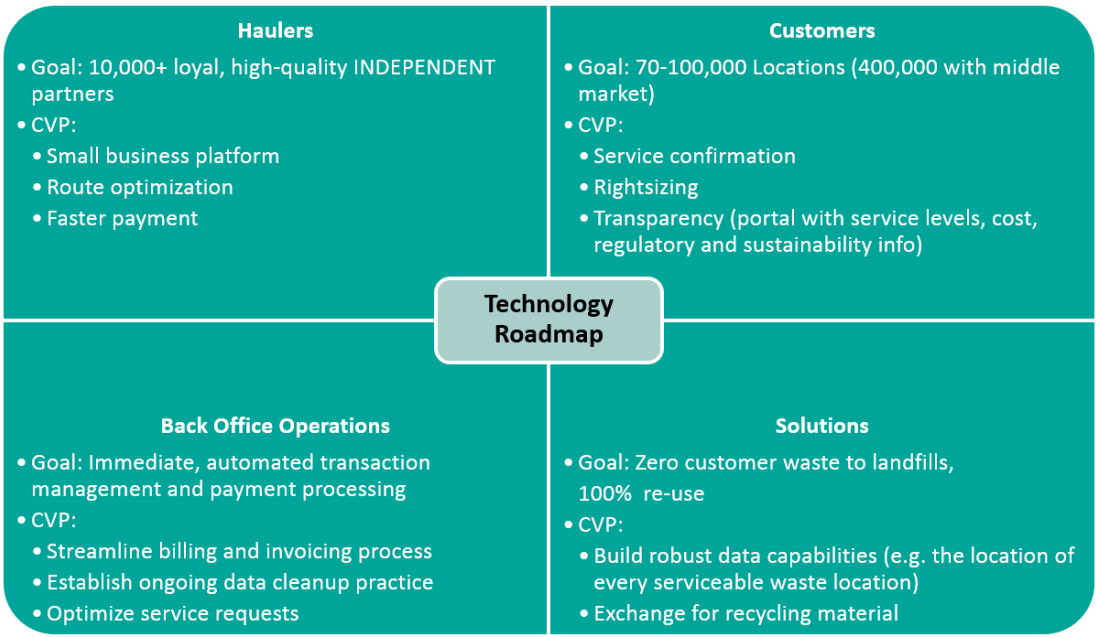
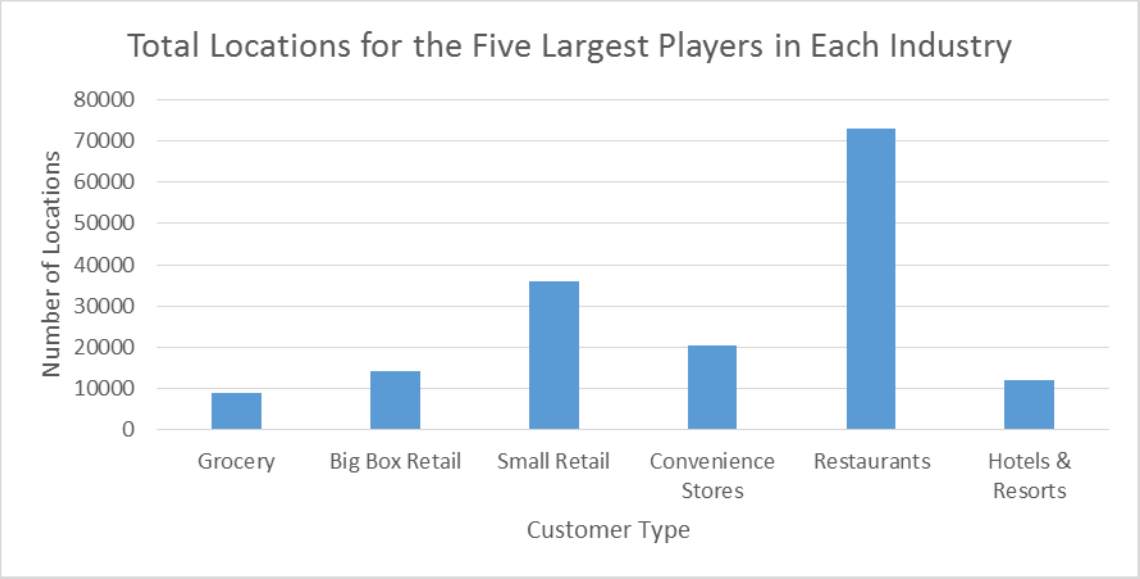
Exhibit 13 Rubicon Technology Roadmap, 2014



Source: Company documents.

Exhibit 14 Potential National Customer Locations, by Industry



Source: IbisWorld, Statista, cspnet.com; casewriter estimates.

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Exhibit 15a Comparable Public Companies

Company Name	Share Price	LTM Revenue ($m)	Shares Outstanding (m)	Market Capitalization ($m)	Net Debt ($m)	Total Enterprise Value ($m)	LTM EBITDA ($m)	Net P&PE / Revenue	EV / EBITDA	EV / Revenue	Total Revenues, 5 Yr CAGR
Waste Management Companies											
Waste Management, Inc. (WM)	$ 48.73	$ 14,059	457.9	$ 22,315	$ 9,981	$ 32,595	$ 3,479	0.88	9.37	2.32	3.4%
Republic Services, Inc. (RSG)	$ 39.61	$ 8,712	355.5	$ 14,083	$ 6,918	$ 21,003	$ 2,501	0.81	8.40	2.41	3.2%
Stericycle, Inc. (SRCL)	$128.92	$ 2,447	84.9	$ 10,948	$ 1,635	$ 12,607	$ 693	0.15	18.20	5.15	16.5%
Waste Connections Inc. (WCN)	$ 47.21	$ 2,039	124.1	$ 5,860	$ 1,896	$ 7,761	$ 699	1.20	11.10	3.81	12.3%
Progressive Waste Solutions (BIN)	$ 26.33	$ 2,006	114.7	$ 3,021	$ 1,457	$ 4,253	$ 513	0.94	8.30	2.12	15.2%
Clean Harbors, Inc. (CLH)	$ 46.75	$ 3,436	59.9	$ 2,803	$ 1,138	$ 3,941	$ 526	0.46	7.49	1.15	28.6%
							Average:	**0.74**	**10.48**	**2.83**	**13.2%**
Asset-Heavy Logistics Companies											
United Parcel Service, Inc. (UPS)	$109.92	$ 57,313	905.2	$ 99,503	$ 6,741	$ 106,261	$ 7,995	0.31	13.29	1.85	4.7%
FedEx Corporation (FDX)	$178.18	$ 46,227	283.2	$ 50,469	$ 2,320	$ 52,789	$ 6,237	0.42	8.46	1.14	6.6%
JB Hunt Transport Services (JBHT)	$ 82.53	$ 6,030	117.2	$ 9,669	$ 834	$ 10,503	$ 884	0.35	11.88	1.74	13.5%
							Average:	**0.36**	**11.21**	**1.58**	**8.3%**
Asset-Light Logistics Companies											
CH Robinson Worldwide Inc. (CHRW)	$ 73.74	$ 13,266	146.3	$ 10,787	$ 717	$ 11,504	$ 765	0.01	15.03	0.87	12.0%
Expeditors International (EXPD)	$ 46.82	$ 6,422	193.0	$ 9,038	$ (1,031)	$ 8,010	$ 621	0.09	12.91	1.25	9.1%
XPO Logistics, Inc. (XPO)	$ 38.68	$ 1,783	65.3	$ 2,526	$ (75)	$ 2,857	$ 55	0.03	51.85	1.60	80.3%
Hub Group Inc. (HUBG)	$ 37.62	$ 3,541	37.4	$ 1,408	$ (20)	$ 1,387	$ 139	0.07	10.02	0.39	18.2%
UTi Worldwide Inc. (UTIW)	$ 11.80	$ 4,285	105.5	$ 1,244	$ 342	$ 1,802	$ 64	0.05	28.11	0.42	4.3%
							Average:	**0.05**	**23.58**	**0.91**	**24.8%**
SaaS Companies											
salesforce.com, inc. (CRM)	$ 59.87	$ 5,074	631.0	$ 37,778	$ 1,425	$ 39,203	$ 169	0.24	232.52	7.73	30.5%
Workday, Inc. (WDAY)	$ 87.05	$ 704	186.0	$ 16,191	$ (1,345)	$ 14,846	$ (157)	0.11	-	21.10	-
ServiceNow, Inc. (NOW)	$ 63.96	$ 610	148.3	$ 9,485	$ (210)	$ 9,276	$ (110)	0.12	-	15.21	-
Zendesk, Inc. (ZEN)	$ 23.76	$ 111	72.8	$ 1,731	$ (103)	$ 1,628	$ (43)	0.08	-	14.67	-
Cornerstone OnDemand, Inc. (CSOD)	$ 31.77	$ 242	53.6	$ 1,701	$ (4)	$ 1,698	$ (60)	0.06	-	7.01	56.7%
							Average:	**0.12**		**13.14**	

Source: Capital IQ (Data as of November 28, 2014), Casewriter calculations.

Exhibit 15b Comparable Private Companies

Company Name	Round	Forward Annual Revenue	Pre-Money Valuation	Post-Money Valuation	Forward Annual Rev. Multiple
Uber	Series E	$ 2,000,000,000	$ 48,000,000,000	$ 50,000,000,000	24.0
AirBnB	Private	$ 900,000,000	$ 24,000,000,000	$ 25,500,000,000	26.7
Dropbox	Series C	$ 400,000,000	$ 9,650,000,000	$ 10,000,000,000	24.4
				Average:	**25.03**

Note: Uber and AirBnB stated revenue is net, not gross or bookings

Sources: wsj.com, forbes.com, crunchbase.com

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Endnotes

[1] New York Times, "Dividing and Conquering the Trash," October 25,2014, http://www.nytimes.com/2014/10/26/business/dividing-and-conquering-the-trash.html?_r=0, accessed September 2015

[2] Waste Management (WM) 8-K filing, "Investor Meetings," September 12, 2011, pg. 9

[3] UC Berkley, "Roman Ceramics are Evidence of Ancient Recycling," January 7, 2010, http://ls.berkeley.edu/?q=arts-ideas/archive/roman-ceramics-are-evidence-ancient-recycling, accessed September 2015

[4] U.S. Global Change Research Program, "2014 National Climate Assessment," http://nca2014.globalchange.gov/, accessed August 2015.

[5] Robert G. Eccles, Ioannis Ioannou, George Serafeim, "The Impact of Corporate Sustainability on Organizational Processes and Performance," NBER Working Paper No. 17950, 2012, http://www.nber.org/papers/w17950, accessed August 2015

[6] B-Corporation, 2014 Annual Report, https://www.bcorporation.net/news-media/annual-report-2014, accessed August 2015

[7] United Nations Environment Programme, "Green Economy Report: Waste," 2011, http://www.unep.org/greeneconomy/Portals/88/documents/ger/GER_8_Waste.pdf

[8] Environmental Protection Agency, Waste Management Annual Report, 2013, http://www.epa.gov/epawaste/nonhaz/municipal/msw99.htm, accessed August 2013

[9] S&P Capital IQ, "Industry Surveys: Environmental & Waste Management", October 2014

[10] Data in this paragraph sourced from Recycling Facilities and Recycled Materials Wholesalers Industry reports, IBISWorld, accessed August 2015.

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